

A non-fiction memoir and a self-help psychology book
dedicated to the author's older sister who died after suffering
from major depression at age 20.

Depression and suicide do *not* happen due to 'mental weakness.' They are worldwide problems with possible causes at both the individual and societal levels. In 2017, U.S. suicide rates reached their highest point in the last several decades with a particular increase in youth suicide rates among 15- to 24-year-olds. South Korea is another country that consistently shows the highest suicide rates among the OECD countries for over 10 years.

This book goes into the types of thought patterns (comparison thinking, catastrophizing, negative self-talk, perfectionism) that may cause obsessive, harmful overthinking known as 'rumination' which has proven to be a major precursor to depression. It also discusses possible solutions for tackling depression and why we need to address cultural issues such as obsession with social status and traditional definition of 'success,' especially in South Korean and Asian communities. We also need to challenge the traditional understanding of depression that claims it's caused by an unexplainable "chemical imbalance in the brain" that can only be addressed by medication.

Also included is an exclusive interview with Dr. Chad Ebesutani, the Founder and Clinic Director of the Seoul Counseling Center, who completed his Doctoral degree in Clinical Psychology at UCLA and is also a Professor of Psychology at Duksung University in South Korea.

"There's so much we can do [in order to advance mental health treatments for patients with depression]. We have figured some important things out, but we are definitely in need of more answers. We have yet to understand what truly works for depression as well as how to communicate that to others. I strongly support individuals like Terry who take the initiative to get the right messages out there. Although there is a lot of suffering in the world, if we continue to push forward and ask the right questions, as Terry has done in his book, I believe we will eventually find our way to a world with less suffering. A meaningful book to share with the world. Thank you Terry." - Dr. Chad Ebesutani, Ph.D (Clinic Director & Licensed Psychologist at Seoul Counseling Center, Professor, Dept. of Psychology at Duksung Women's University)



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